Practice workbook · Activation Synthesis Theory of dreaming

Hobson and McCarley's view that dreams arise from random REM activation, sensory blockade and movement inhibition.

5 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 4 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-SLP-08

1. Question 31 · part whole · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.

31 Belinda attends a sleep clinic. The clinician attaches electrodes to her head and arms which will measure brain wave activity and muscle movement during sleep. Whilst Belinda is asleep, high levels of brain wave activity are recorded but at the same time there is little or no muscle movement.

Explain **one** reason for the levels of brain wave activity and muscle movement recorded whilst Belinda was asleep.

You must use Activation Synthesis Theory (Hobson and McCarley, 1977) to justify your answer.

(Total for Question 31 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

2. Question 33 · part whole · 2 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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33 Sergio was describing a dream to Juan. Sergio dreamt he met his family in a house he used to live in, but the decoration of the house was the same as his office at work. His primary school teacher was making cakes in the kitchen.

Sergio thinks the dream had a meaning, but Juan said the dream had no meaning.

Explain **one** reason why Juan believed the dream had no meaning.

You must use a theory to justify your answer.

(Total for Question 33 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

3. Question 31 · part whole · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

31 Betty used a new sleep monitoring app on her smartwatch to record her sleep cycle. At several different points during the night when Betty was asleep, her app recorded an increase in the activity in her brain and a decrease in her physical movement.

Explain **one** reason why Betty's brain activity showed increases while she was asleep.

You must use a theory to justify your answer.

(Total for Question 31 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

4. Question 29 · part whole · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

29 Describe how random activation could account for dreaming.

(Total for Question 29 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

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5. Question 32 · part whole · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

32 Archie dreamt that he was running through a forest with his best friend and his grandma. As they came towards the end of the forest there was a large office building in front of them with a gorilla sitting in the doorway eating a pizza. The gorilla waved at Archie, who then fell through a hole that appeared in the floor. He then woke up.

Explain **one** reason why Archie may have had this dream.

You must use Activation Synthesis Theory to justify your answer.

(Total for Question 32 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer